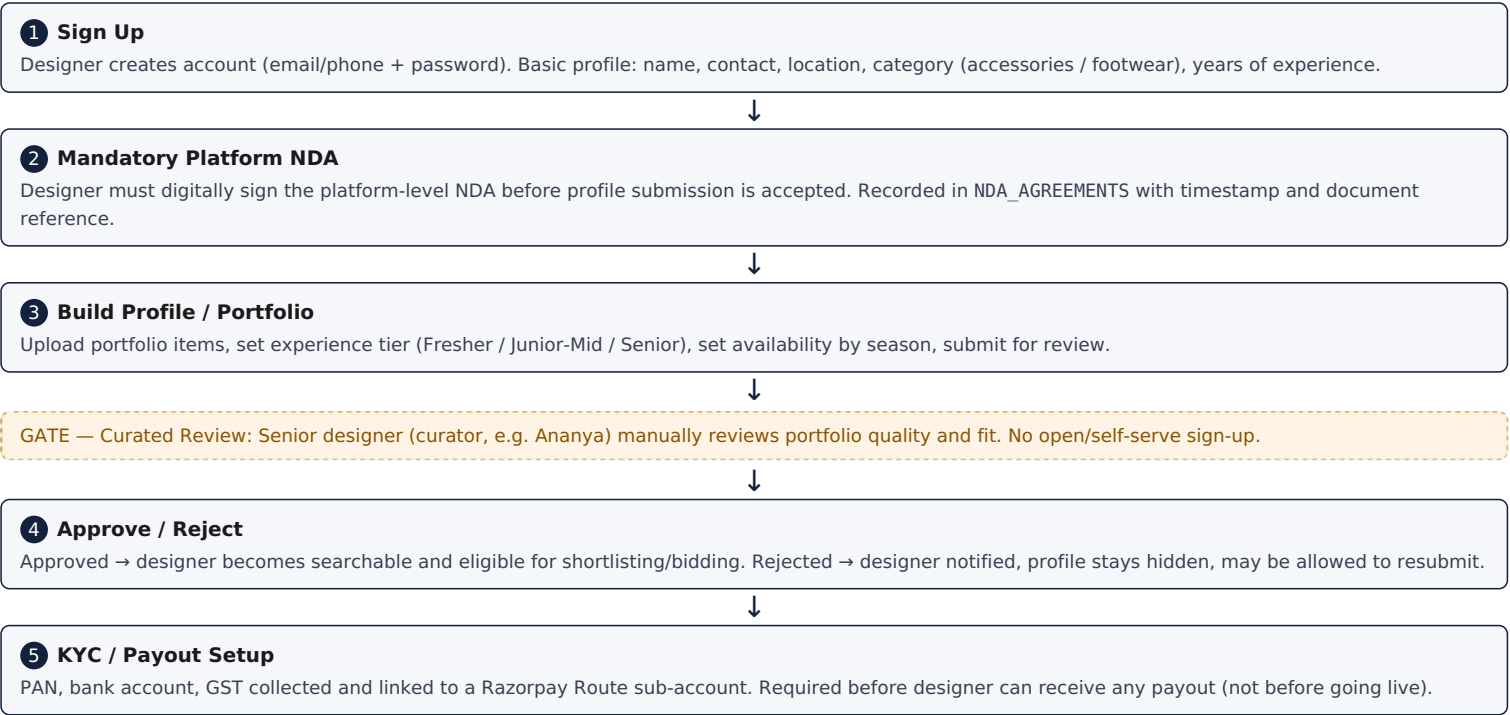


Overall Technical Workflow

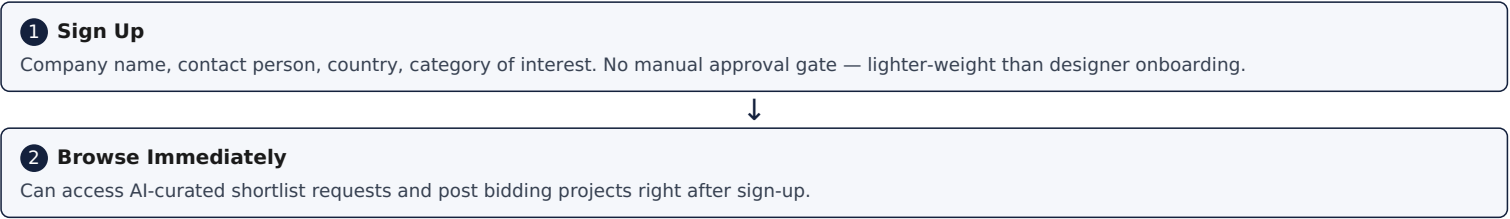
Designer-Manufacturer Marketplace Platform — End-to-End System Flow

1. Onboarding Workflow

Designer Onboarding Designer



Manufacturer Onboarding Manufacturer

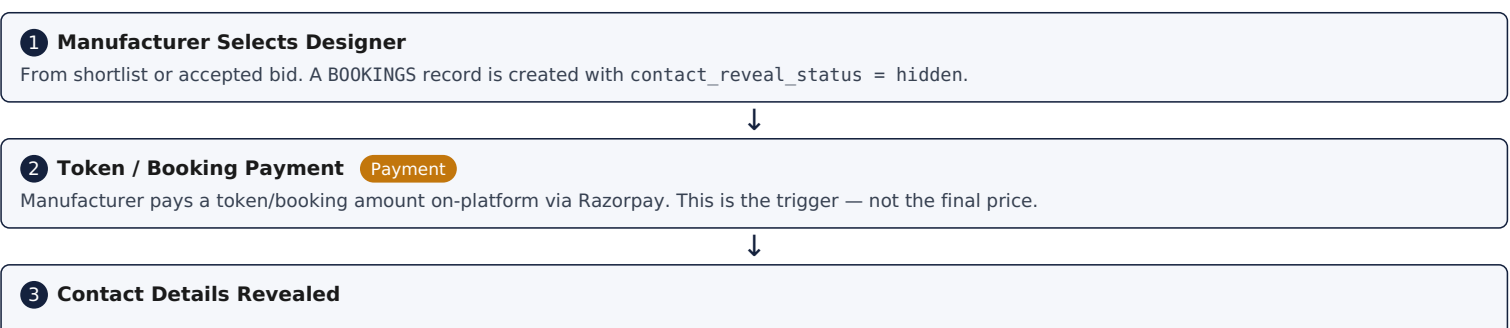


2. Discovery Workflow — Two Parallel Paths

Path	How it Works	System Behavior
A. AI-Curated Shortlist	Manufacturer submits a project brief. System generates a shortlist of 3 designers matched on category, tier, availability, and price fit.	Creates AI_SHORTLISTS + 3 SHORTLIST_DESIGNERS records. Manufacturer selects one to proceed to booking.
B. Bidding	Manufacturer pays a listing fee to post an open project. Designers within the matching price range submit bids (price, timeline, pitch).	Creates PROJECT_LISTINGS (fee gated via LISTING_FEE_TRANSACTIONS) + BIDS. Bidding window auto-closes; manufacturer accepts one bid.

GATE — Monthly Caps: Both designer bid submissions and manufacturer listing posts are capped per month (tracked in MONTHLY_CAPS) to prevent spam and preserve curation quality.

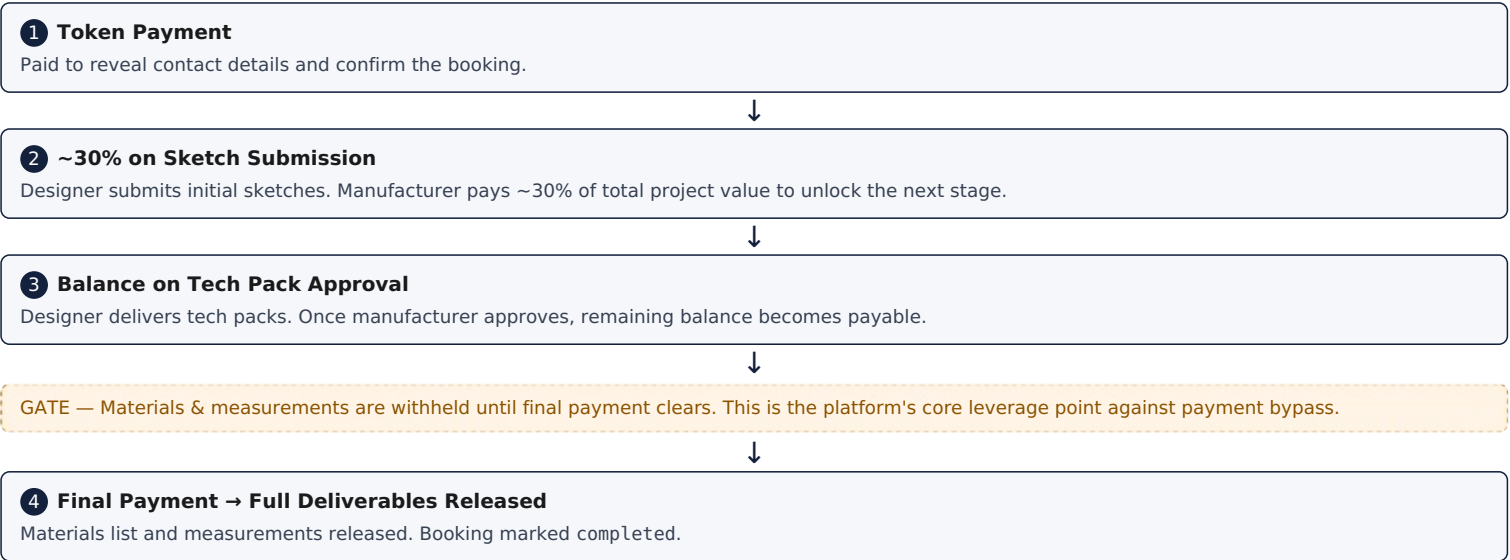
3. Booking & Contact-Reveal Workflow



contact_reveal_status flips to revealed only after token payment clears. This is the core anti-leakage mechanism — no direct contact is possible before payment.

4. Staged Payment Workflow

Unlike a single lump-sum payment, the total project value is broken into gated stages. Each stage must clear before the next deliverable is unlocked.



Split Logic (applies at every stage)

Component	Share	Mechanism
Platform Commission	40%	Auto-deducted via Razorpay Route split at each stage settlement
Designer Payout	60%	Released to designer's linked Razorpay Route sub-account once stage is marked paid

Confirm with Faraz/legal whether 40% applies per-stage or only on total project value — affects the TRANSACTIONS calculation logic.

5. Trust, Safety & Curation Workflow

- Payment bypass detection:** not automatable — relies on a "Report User" flow reviewed by admin, not system-triggered detection.
- Flag → Debar → Ban:** Admin action recorded in FLAGS_BANS; banned users lose platform access immediately, existing in-progress bookings frozen pending manual review.
- NDA enforcement:** Platform NDA is systemic (signed at onboarding); exporter-specific NDAs are encouraged but tracked as separate optional documents per booking.
- Curation:** No designer becomes visible/bookable without curator sign-off — this is a permanent gate, not a one-time launch step.

6. System Architecture Overview

Frontend / Backend Next.js — handles manufacturer & designer dashboards, booking flows, admin panel	Database / Auth / Storage Supabase (PostgreSQL) — stores all entities per the ER model, handles auth and portfolio file storage	Hosting Vercel — frontend + serverless functions	Payments Razorpay Route — staged split payments, sub-accounts per designer for automated payout
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Key Automated Triggers

Trigger Event	System Action
Curator approves designer	Designer profile becomes searchable; notification sent to designer
Token payment confirmed	Contact details unlocked on both dashboards; notification sent to both parties
Sketch stage payment confirmed	Next deliverable stage unlocked for designer to begin tech pack
Final payment confirmed	Materials/measurements released; booking marked complete; review prompt triggered
Bidding window expires	Listing auto-closes; manufacturer notified to select a bid or listing marked expired
Monthly cap reached	Further bid/listing submissions blocked until next cycle

7. Notes for Legal / Marketing Alignment

- Avoid encoding a specific public delivery commitment (e.g. "21 days") into system-generated communications, invoices, or contracts — use approximate framing only, pending lawyer review.
- Platform should be architecturally country-agnostic from the start (currency, language-ready fields) to support later UK/Italy/Spain designer onboarding without schema changes.